Sleep Monitoring Dashboard

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1 Motivation and Objective

I have been an athlete for roughly 19 years. I started playing golf when I was four years old and quickly progressed through the junior ranks. Throughout middle school and high school, I won several national and international titles, which eventually helped me earn a scholarship to play NCAA Division I golf at Seattle University.

Division I golf is extremely competitive and represents the highest level of collegiate golf in the United States [1]. At that level, I quickly learned how much sleep, nutrition and mental preparation affected my performance, both on and off the golf course.

Towards the end of my freshman year, I bought myself a WHOOP band [6] (Figure 1). Initially, I just wanted to see how well I was sleeping. Over time, however, I became particularly interested in the journal feature [5], which allowed me to record habits and compare them with my sleep and recovery measurements. It gave me a better idea of what seemed to help and what didn't.

From that point on, I became very interested in sleep. I started reading research papers, blogs, attending workshops hosted by SeattleU Athletics and paying a lot more attention to my sleeping habits. I don't necessarily enjoy sleeping more than the next person, but I care about sleeping well and recovering properly so that I can perform at my full potential. The importance of sleep for athletic performance and recovery has also been discussed extensively in the literature [4].

Remark: To this day, Walsh et al. [4] remains one of my favorite papers on sleep and performance in elite athletes.

When I was tasked with designing a dashboard, sleep monitoring was therefore the first thing that came to mind. I wanted to approach the assignment from a slightly different perspective: rather than creating a dashboard for an athlete to track their own sleep, I wanted to imagine that I was the researcher conducting a sleep study.

2 Target Group and Dashboard Concept

The intended users are clinicians, sports scientists and researchers monitoring sleep in athletes. For the remainder of this report, let CLRSH denote the clinician, researcher, or principal investigator using the dashboard. The dashboards displayed previously collected data; no new study was conducted.

The dashboard consists of two views. The first is an overview of the entire study population (Figure 2). It is designed to give CLRSH a quick summary of the collected measurements without having to inspect each participant individually.

In particular, the overview should help answer questions such as:

Q1. How much sleep are the athletes getting on average, and how many fall below seven hours?

Q2. Which athletes sleep the most or least and are there noticeable differences across weekdays?

The second view, is an individual overview (Figure 3), it focuses on individual athletes and selected subgroups. Here, CLRSH can examine sleep duration, variability and deviations from the selected

average.

The dashboard also includes adjustable filters for participants, weekdays, matchday categories as well as caffeine consumption. This makes it possible to investigate more specific questions.

Q3. How does sleep duration differ between observations with different reported levels of caffeine consumption?

Q4. Do athletes show different sleep patterns depending on the timing of a match?

Remark: These questions are exploratory. The dashboard is intended to help identify patterns worth investigating, rather than establish why those patterns occur.

3 Dataset Selection

I chose the REST study dataset [2] because it was made publicly available post hoc, after the study had already been completed. The dataset was obtained from Zenodo [3] and was published in a form I could use directly. I did not change the source records, although some observations were excluded from particular calculations when the required values were missing.

The study followed 21 elite female football players over a period of 17 days. Data were collected using wearable devices (actigraphy), questionnaires and other measurements related to sleep and daily habits. These included sleep duration, caffeine intake, screen time, soreness and well-being. The dates were anonymized for privacy reasons.

I chose this dataset mainly because it contained both sleep measurements and information about habits that might influence sleep. This allowed me to display and examine athletes as a group, for example by filtering caffeine intake, while also comparing individual athletes under different conditions, such as time relative to matchday.

4 Visualizations

Average Sleep by Athlete

A horizontal bar chart was used to display the average sleep duration for each athlete. I chose this visualization because it made comparisons between athletes fairly straightforward. The bars were sorted by sleep duration, making it easy to identify which athletes slept the most and which slept the least on average.

This was particularly useful in the overview dashboard, where the goal was to get a quick understanding of the entire group without looking at individual records.

Sleep Across the Week

A heatmap was used to display sleep duration across different weekdays. Each cell represented an average sleep duration, with color indicating whether the value was relatively high or low.

I chose a heatmap because it made it easier to spot patterns across athletes and weekdays without having to compare a large number of individual bars. It also allowed the user to see whether certain athletes tended to sleep more or less on particular days.

Sleep Duration Distribution

A histogram was used to show the distribution of recorded sleep durations. Rather than only displaying an average, this visualization showed how frequently these different sleep durations occurred.

I included this because an average alone simply does not tell the whole story. Two groups could have a similar average sleep duration while having very different distributions. The histogram made it easier to see where most observations were concentrated and whether unusually short or long sleep durations were present.

5 Software Selection

I used Tableau Desktop for macOS [7] to build both dashboards. The main reason for choosing Tableau was that Microsoft Power BI does not run natively on macOS and I did not want to build the entire dashboard using Python.

Tableau allowed me to create calculated fields for the individual KPIs, which were then displayed on the dashboards. I also used it to create several charts and graphs to better understand the data. Each visualization was developed on a separate worksheet before being combined into the final dashboards.

Another useful feature was the ability to add interactive filters. These allowed users to select individual athletes, filter observations by weekday, caffeine consumption, and time relative to matchday, or adjust certain thresholds. I also added navigation buttons to switch between the overview and individual dashboards, making it easier to move between the two without having to open separate worksheets.

Working with Tableau was very frustrating at times, particularly when it came to formatting and configuring the dashboards. Still, I got there in the end :).

6 Limitations and Conclusion

The biggest limitations were the small sample size ($n = 21$) and the relatively short observation period ($t = 17$ days). The analysis was descriptive rather than causal, which made some of the variables I initially found interesting difficult to interpret meaningfully.

Despite these limitations, the dashboards provided a simple way to explore the available data, compare athletes and identify patterns that might be worth investigating further.

7 Use of Generative AI

Generative AI (OpenAI ChatGPT, GPT-6) was used to assist with exploratory data analysis, interpreting statistical measures, finding and understanding Tableau documentation, troubleshooting Tableau and LaTeX and editing the wording and references in this report. The personal motivation and dashboard work were my own. I retain responsibility for the analytical decisions, verification of results and the final dashboards.

References

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[3] Boeker, M., Thambawita, V., Riegler, M., & Midoglu, C. (2025). *Exploring Sleep Patterns and Influencing Factors in Elite Female Football Athletes* (Version 4) [Dataset]. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.16937033

[4] Walsh, N. P., Halson, S. L., Sargent, C., et al. (2021). Sleep and the athlete: Narrative review and 2021 expert consensus recommendations. *British Journal of Sports Medicine*, 55(7), 356–368. https://doi.org/10.1136/bjsports-2020-102025

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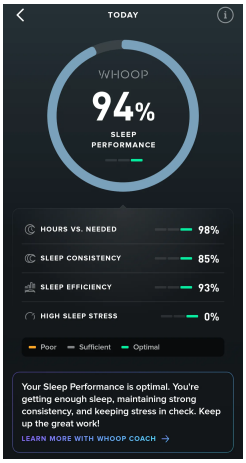
[6] WHOOP. (n.d.). *WHOOP 101*. https://developer.whoop.com/docs/whoop-101/ (Accessed: November 8, 2026).

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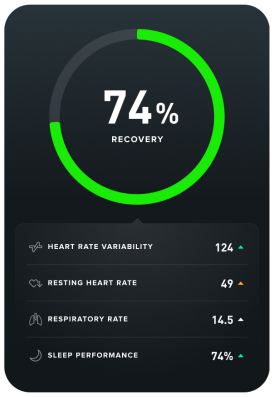
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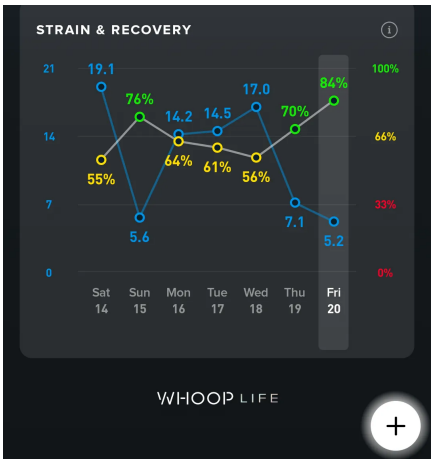
A Supplementary Figures



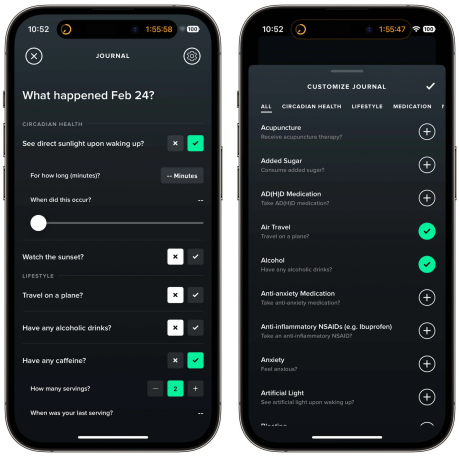
(a) Sleep overview



(b) Recovery metrics



(c) Strain monitoring



(d) Journal

Figure 1: WHOOP monitoring features, including sleep, recovery, strain and the journal. Source: WHOOP app screenshots (see [6, 5]).

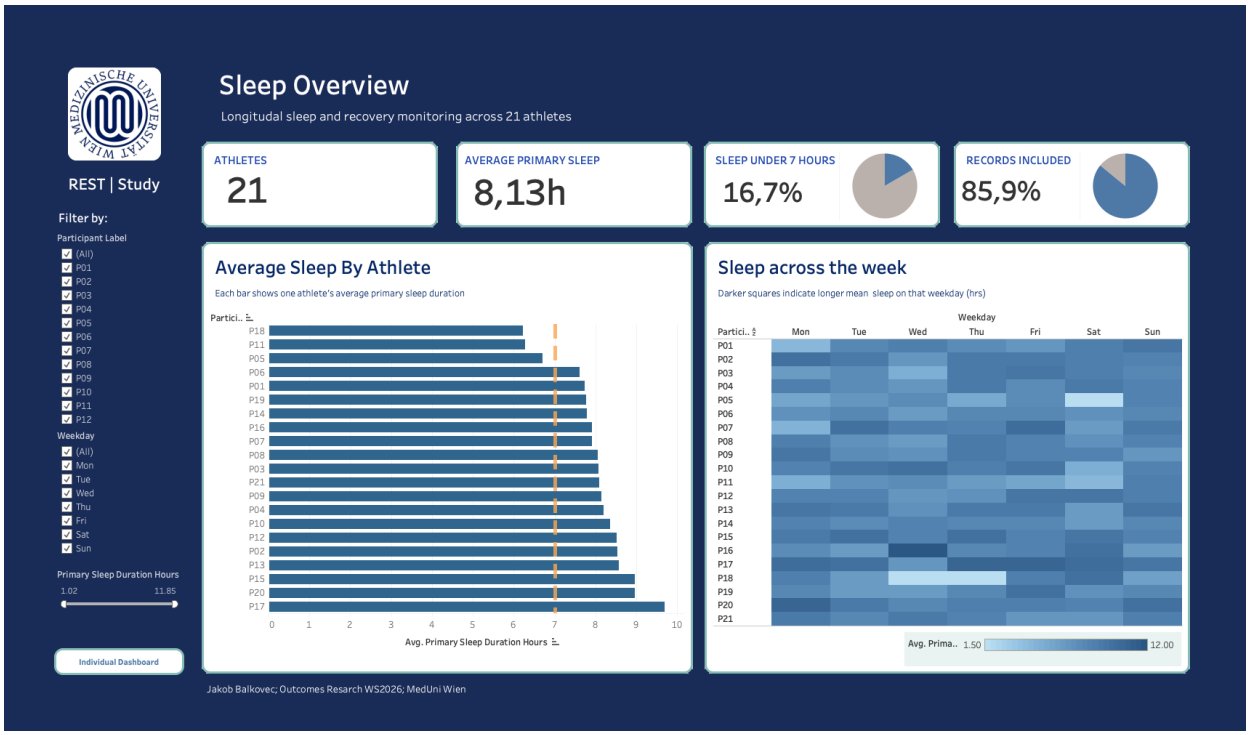


Figure 2: Sleep Overview dashboard displaying study-level measurements, participant comparisons and weekday sleep patterns. Author's own Tableau dashboard.

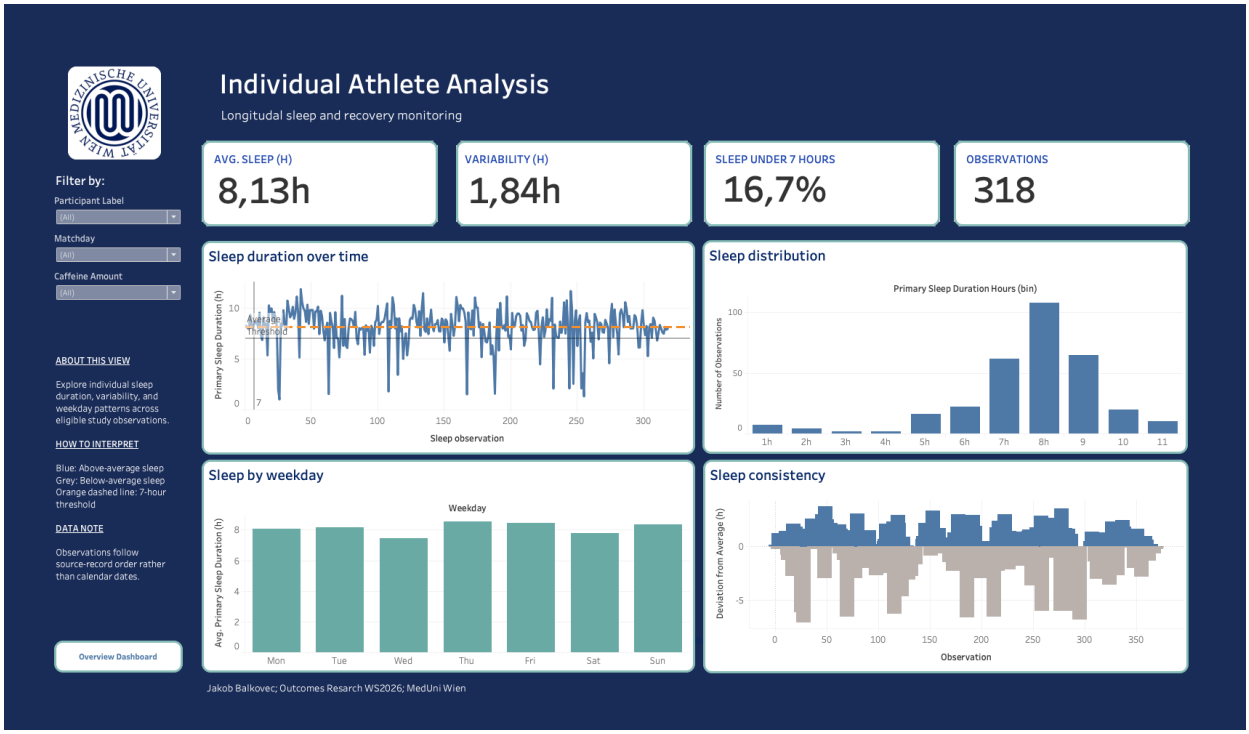


Figure 3: Individual Athlete Analysis dashboard showing sleep distributions, variability and participant-level filtering. Author's own Tableau dashboard.